



HIGH SCHOOL • 9TH - 12TH GRADE

Mountain Bike Training 101

A simple guide to getting faster, stronger, and stoked — the Pioneer way.

STRONG BODY ♦ STRONG MIND ♦ STRONG CHARACTER ♦ ALL INCLUSIVE ♦ TOTAL EQUALITY

01 WHY WE TRAIN

- **Training beats talent.** Consistent riders pass naturally fast riders by mid-season.
- **Train smart, race well.** The goal isn't to suffer the most — it's to be ready when it counts.
- **Build the engine now.** The fitness you build all summer is the fitness you race on in fall.

02 THE THREE TRAINING ZONES

- **Easy (Zone 2):** Can hold a full conversation. Builds your aerobic base. *This is most of your riding.*
- **Medium (Tempo/Threshold):** Short sentences only. Builds race-pace strength.
- **Hard (Intervals):** One or two words. Builds top-end power. Short doses, big effect.
- **Easy days easy, hard days hard.** Mushy middle = slow gains and burnout.

03 BUILDING A WEEK

- **2–3 team rides + 1–2 solo rides.** Mix of easy spins, skill work, and one harder session.
- **One real rest day.** Adaptation happens when you rest, not when you ride.
- **Skills count as training.** Cornering, braking, and line choice make you faster than fitness alone.
- **10% rule:** Don't jump weekly volume by more than ~10% — that's how injuries start.

04 FUEL, SLEEP, RECOVER

- **Eat before you ride.** Skipping breakfast = bonking by mile 8.
- **Carbs on the bike.** Anything over 75 minutes? Bring food. 30–60g carbs/hour.
- **Hydrate early.** If you're thirsty, you're already behind. Add electrolytes when it's hot.
- **Sleep is free watts.** 8–9 hours. No exceptions in race weeks.
- **Refuel within 30 min** after hard rides — protein + carbs.

05 HEAD GAME

- **Process over outcome.** Focus on the next corner, not the finish line.
- **Bad days happen.** One ugly workout doesn't define your season.
- **Compare to yesterday's you,** not the rider next to you.
- **Have fun.** Riders who enjoy training keep training. That's the whole game.

06 ACTION ITEMS

- Pick a consistent **bedtime** and stick to it each night.
- Do **one** ride at a true easy pace — fully conversational the whole time.
- Practice **one skill** for 10 minutes before or after a team ride.
- Check in with a coach if something feels off — pain, fatigue, or burnout.

"TRAIN HARD. RACE WELL. RIDE TOGETHER."LEHI MTB
PIONEER STRONG